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Arab Open University

Name .....
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FACULTY OF BUSINESS STUDIES

BUC111
BUSINESS COMMUNICATION 1

FINAL Examination / Version: B

2025-2026 / SPRING

8 – June – 2026

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Number of Exam Pages: 5 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF"** mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
5- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examination
6- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
7- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signature
Part I	**10**	**30 minutes**	**25**		
Part II	**5**	**30 minutes**	**25**		
Part III	**3**	**30 minutes**	**25**		
Part IV	**2**	**30 minutes**	**25**		
Total	**18**	**120 minutes**	**100**		

Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (25 marks)

1. Why is it beneficial to recognize employees' efforts?
   A) It boosts morale and motivates continued high performance
   B) It eliminates the need for corrective feedback
   C) It replaces formal performance appraisals
   D) It fulfills company regulations
2. In a routine request, the body of the message should?
   A) Apologize repeatedly
   B) Provide details and justification
   C) Repeat the closing
   D) Add unrelated information
3. A request for a recommendation should use which approach
   A) Indirect
   B) Persuasive
   C) Direct
   D) Emotional
4. When answering a customer complaint, which step comes first?
   A) Explain company policy
   B) Offer compensation
   C) Acknowledge receipt of the complaint
   D) Transfer responsibility
5. What is the best way to begin an application rejection message?
   A) State the rejection immediately in the first sentence
   B) Apologize repeatedly for the decision
   C) Begin with a polite thank-you for applying
   D) Explain company hiring policies in detail
6. Which of the following is an appropriate guideline when delivering a termination message?
   A) Send the letter by email to avoid confrontation
   B) Include personal criticism to justify the decision
   C) Deliver the message in person in a private, interruption-free meeting
   D) Avoid explaining the reasons to prevent arguments
7. Which of the following is an example of a hasty generalization in a business situation?
   A) "Our last two clients complained about our service; therefore, all our clients will be dissatisfied."
   B) "Sales usually increase during December, so we should prepare extra inventory for the holiday season."
   C) "We need to reduce costs because our competitor has lower prices."
   D) "Customer feedback is important, so we should send out a survey after every purchase."
8. What does the "A" in the **A**IDA model stand for?
   A) Approach
   B) Awareness
   C) Attention
   D) Attraction

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9. What is crucial when trying to persuade an audience that is doubtful or resistant?
   A) Using humor and casual language
   B) Applying pressure or threats
   C) Manipulating emotions
   D) Establishing credibility

10. Why is authenticity important for companies in social media marketing?
   A) It allows companies to hide mistakes from the public
   B) It builds trust by showing transparency and honesty
   C) It ensures all content is strictly promotional
   D) It replaces the need for customer engagement

Part II: Read the sentences below and determine: **(25 marks)**

a) What type of message is it? (Routine or Positive / Negative / Persuasive)
b) What specific kind of message is it? (e.g., Rejection or Refusal, Request for action or information, Performance Review, Termination, Marketing, Sales, Fostering Goodwill, etc.)

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1. " We regret to inform you that your application for the Marketing Manager position was not successful."
   a) What type of message is it? ----------
   b) What specific kind of message is it? ----------

2. " We are excited to invite you to our upcoming webinar on leadership skills. Register today to secure your spot!"
   a) What type of message is it? ----------
   b) What specific kind of message is it? ----------

3. " Please submit the quarterly sales report by Friday, November 29."
   a) What type of message is it? ----------
   b) What specific kind of message is it? ----------

4. " Our company is offering a 20% discount on all software packages this month. Don't miss this opportunity!"
   a) What type of message is it? ----------
   b) What specific kind of message is it? ----------

5. " Thank you for your continued partnership. We value your feedback and look forward to serving you in the future."
   a) What type of message is it? ----------
   b) What specific kind of message is it? ----------

Part III: Answer the following questions: **(25 marks)**

a) What is a ***resale***, and in which types of customer messages should it be used?

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b) What are the THREE **challenges of sending and receiving negative messages**?

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------

c) Mention THREE **planning steps for marketing and sales messages.**

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------

Part IV: Evaluating and Crafting Business Messages: Read the case below, then answer the questions that follow. (25 marks)

Background: Your company, *Eco Smart Gadgets*, has developed a new "Smart Energy Monitoring" software that helps companies save electricity and reduce costs. Your target is *tech* companies in the Arabian Gulf. Most of these companies have recently invested heavily in improving their own software, so budget concerns may make them hesitant.

Questions:

1. Which ***approach*** should you take to convince these companies switch to your software? **Justify** your answer

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2. Write a *persuasive email* to the tech companies encouraging them to subscribe to the "Smart Energy Monitoring" software. Your goal is to convince them to try the software, highlighting its benefits, addressing potential objections, and motivating them to act. Follow the criteria for writing effective persuasive messages (e.g., use the AIDA model, highlight key selling points and benefits, address possible objections, and end with a clear call to action).

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To:
Subject:

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- End of Questions -